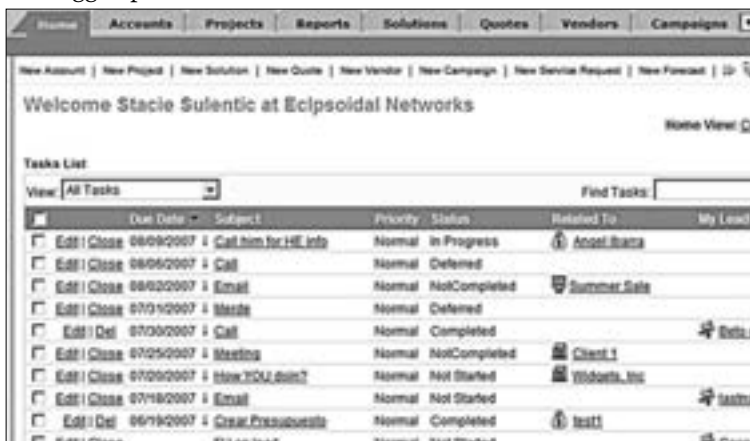


the customer. It's free for the first three users and \$12 (Rs 600) per month for each additional user. That's a pretty good deal considering that Salesforce.com, the 300 kg gorilla of the CRM space, charges \$600 (promotional pricing—may go up later) for their cheapest, five-user group edition, which in comparison would cost \$288 for five users at Zoho. Salesforce has a greater depth of functionality, of course, but the complexity may be overkill if your sales processes aren't that mature. Besides, if you have a small two to three-person sales team, you can't beat the price—free!

At an extra \$3 (Rs 125) per user, you can also get integration with MS Outlook, which allows you to synchronise your Outlook contacts, and also enables e-mailing in support requests that will initiate a new support ticket (known as Case in Zoho CRM). What's missing is calendar synchronisation and Thunderbird / Lightning support. In comparison, Salesforce is also limited to Outlook, though the level of integration is deeper.

If you're new to CRM systems, at first glance it may seem overwhelming. The tricky part is to get your users to be consistent in using the system on a regular basis. That can only be achieved by dogged persistence.



Whip your sales team into shape!